Practice workbook · Why consumers may not maximise their benefit

The assumption that consumers aim to maximise benefit, and the reasons they fall short: poor calculation, habits and copying others.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: ECO-T11-05

1. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

2023 JAN · Paper 01 (regional R)

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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4 Figure 6 shows financial data for a firm selling a selection of products.

Product	X	Y
Price	$3 000	$3 300
Quantity sold	50	40
Total revenue	$3 000 × 50	$3 300 × 40
PED	−0.62	−1.53

Figure 6

(a) Calculate the **total revenue** for the product that has a price elasticity of demand (PED) which is **inelastic**. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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1. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

For a number of years there has been an increase in obesity in Poland. Consumers of sugary drinks, such as Coca Cola and Fanta, now have to pay an additional 0.50 zloty ($0.11) per litre, following the introduction of a sugar tax. At the same time, there has been an increase in adverts for soft drinks. However, consumers are still buying these drinks even though they are now more expensive.

(Source adapted from: https://retailmarketexperts.com/en/news/2021-retail-tax-and-sugar-tax-come-into-force/)

(b) With reference to the data above and your knowledge of economics, analyse the reasons why consumers may not maximise their benefit when consuming sugary drinks.

(6)

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1. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

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1. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks

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Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

NT Massage is a small but successful, family-run business in a residential part of Hong Kong. It offers traditional foot and head massages to local residents, many of whom have been customers for many years.

A younger member of the family, Mei, would like to expand the business. She wants to open a chain of shops offering foot and head massages in busier areas of Hong Kong. She would like her new employees to be fully trained, to advertise in hotels and to focus more attention on attracting custom from the 7.5 million population of Hong Kong.

Even though there would be competition from many other similar businesses, additional custom from tourists and business people would enable NT Massage to charge higher prices in the new shops.

(c) With reference to the data above and your knowledge of economics, evaluate whether the family should expand the business rather than keeping it small.

(12)

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1. Question 4 · part b · 6 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 2 · part g · 3 marks

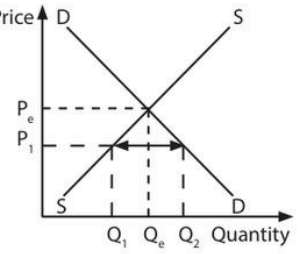
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Further practice · Attempt part g only.

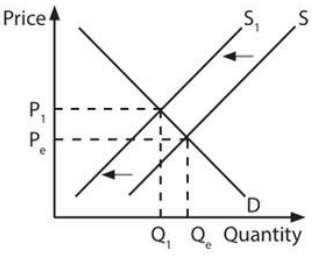
2 (a) Which **one** of the following diagrams shows excess supply?

(1)

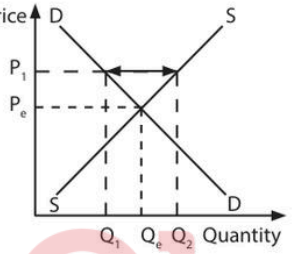
☒ **A**



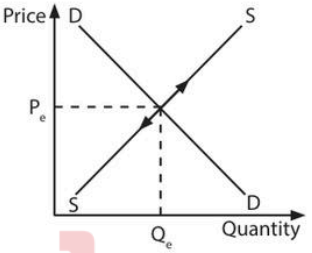
☒ **B**



☒ **C**



☒ **D**



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2. Question 2 · part g · 3 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part g only.

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(b) Which **one** of the following is most likely to create a barrier to entry?

(1)

- ☒ **A** Government provides subsidies for new firms
- ☒ **B** Increasing personal incomes in the economy
- ☒ **C** Low start-up costs
- ☒ **D** Use of expensive technology

(c) Calculate the **price elasticity of demand (PED)** for a product if price falls by 10% and quantity demanded increases by 19%. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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(d) State the formula for social benefits.

(1)

(e) Define the term consumer.

(1)

2. Question 2 · part g · 3 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part g only.

(f) Describe **one** factor that may influence the growth of a firm.

(2)

There are many health warnings about the dangers of eating too much sugar but some consumers continue to do so.

(g) Explain **one** reason why consumers may still make this decision.

(3)

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2. Question 2 · part g · 3 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part g only.

Sea cucumbers are marine animals that have an important role in keeping the coral reef ecosystem healthy. US firm, Orient Seafood Production (OSP), has been fined $1.5m for over-harvesting sea cucumbers. Harvesting sea cucumbers is legal in the US. There is a limit on the quantity allowed to be harvested due to their positive impact on the coral reefs.

OSP was accused of under-reporting harvests by 113,400 kg during a two-year period. Before he paid the fine, the firm's owner had made high profits from sales to China, where there is an increasing demand.

(Source adapted from: https://www.independent.co.uk/news/world/americas/sea-cucumbers-prison-over-harvesting-orient-seafood-production-hoon-namkoong-washington-a8562046.html)

(h) With reference to the data above and your knowledge of economics, assess the effectiveness of government fines when dealing with externalities such as over-harvesting sea cucumbers.

(9)

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2. Question 2 · part g · 3 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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3. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

2

Market share by firm for a market in Azerbaijan

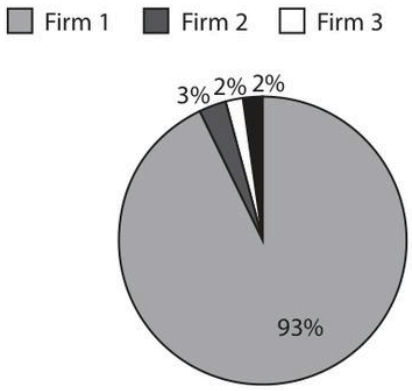


Figure 3

(a) Which **one** of the following options is the most suitable term for the type of market shown in Figure 3?

(1)

- ☒ **A** Cartel
- ☒ **B** Oligopoly
- ☒ **C** Monopoly
- ☒ **D** Competitive

(b) Which **one** of the following is a reason why consumers may not maximise their benefit?

(1)

- ☒ **A** Consumers may accurately calculate the satisfaction they gain
- ☒ **B** Consumers may have habits that are hard to give up
- ☒ **C** Consumers are always rational when making decisions
- ☒ **D** Consumers never copy the behaviour of others

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3. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

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Further practice · Attempt part b only.

(c) State the formula for price elasticity of supply (PES).

(1)

Figure 4 shows some of the production costs in the month of May for a firm manufacturing football souvenirs in Qatar, in preparation for the 2022 World Cup.

Production costs	Qatari Riyal (QR)
Rent	5 000
Raw materials	2 000
Advertising	500
Labour (paid according to output)	15 000

Figure 4

(d) Calculate the **total variable costs** for the firm in the month of May. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

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3. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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4. Question 2 · part f · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part f only.

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2 (a) Which **one** of the following products has demand that is price elastic?

(1)

		Product	Price elasticity of demand (PED)
☒	**A**	**W**	−1.5
☒	**B**	**X**	−1
☒	**C**	**Y**	−0.5
☒	**D**	**Z**	1

(b) Which **one** of the following is a situation when firms in a growing industry all benefit from lower average costs?

(1)

☒ **A** Internal economies of scale

☒ **B** External economies of scale

☒ **C** Diseconomies of scale

☒ **D** Technical economies of scale

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(c) State **one** disadvantage to firms of increased competition.

(1)

4. Question 2 · part f · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part f only.

A firm has total fixed costs of $75 000 per month and variable costs of $525 per unit. It produces 1350 units per month.

(d) Calculate the **total costs per month** for the firm. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

(e) Define the term takeover.

(1)

(f) Describe **one** reason why consumers do not always maximise their benefit from the consumption of a product.

(2)

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4. Question 2 · part f · 2 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part f only.

Figure 2 shows the supply of wheat in a region during 2019.

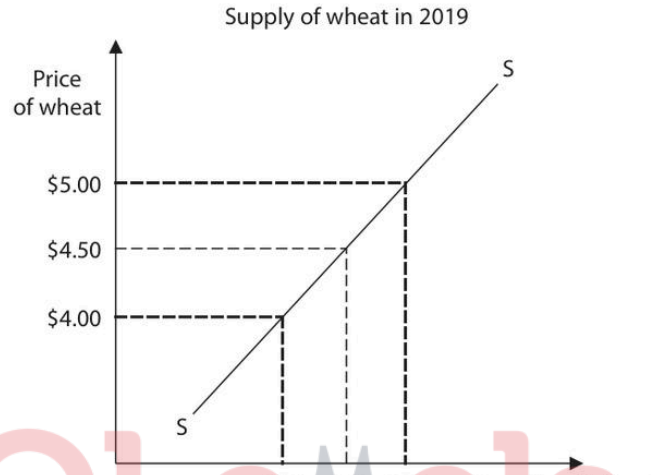


Figure 2

(g) Explain **one** effect on the supply curve of wheat following a change in the price of wheat.

(3)

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4. Question 2 · part f · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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5. Question 3 · part d · 6 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part d only.

3 Income elasticity of demand (YED) for a product is –0.43 and the price elasticity of demand (PED) for the same product is –0.27.

(a) The data above shows that the product is

(1)

- ☒ **A** an inferior good and demand is price inelastic
- ☒ **B** an inferior good and demand is price elastic
- ☒ **C** a normal good and demand is price inelastic
- ☒ **D** a normal good and demand is price elastic

(b) The formula for social benefits is

(1)

- ☒ **A** private costs + private benefits
- ☒ **B** private benefits – private costs
- ☒ **C** private benefits + external benefits
- ☒ **D** private costs – external costs

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5. Question 3 · part d · 6 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part d only.

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(c) On the diagram below, draw the effects of a decrease in the retirement age on the labour market in a country. Label the new curve, the new equilibrium wage rate and the new equilibrium quantity of workers employed.

(3)

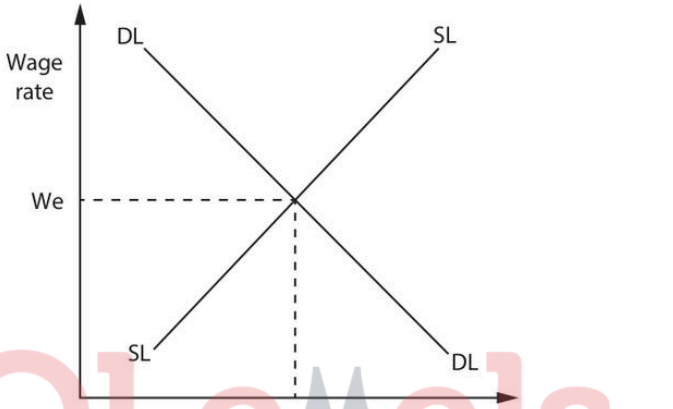


Figure 4

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5. Question 3 · part d · 6 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part d only.

Studies have shown that there are a number of negative impacts from spending too much time using a mobile phone. These include pain in the thumbs, loss of sleep and anxiety. Despite this, it is not unusual for people to spend a lot of time using their phone, even in the presence of others.

(d) With reference to the data above and your knowledge of economics, analyse why some people may ignore the negative impacts of spending a lot of time using a mobile phone.

(6)

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5. Question 3 · part d · 6 marks

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Further practice · Attempt part d only.



5. Question 3 · part d · 6 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part d only.

Manufacturing is an important part of any economy because as well as providing many products, it generates income and tax revenue. Governments can use this tax revenue to provide things such as health care and education, which are part of the tertiary sector.

(e) With reference to the data above and your knowledge of economics, assess the role of the secondary sector in an economy.

(9)

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5. Question 3 · part d · 6 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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6. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

2

Market share by sales of firms in a market in Kuwait

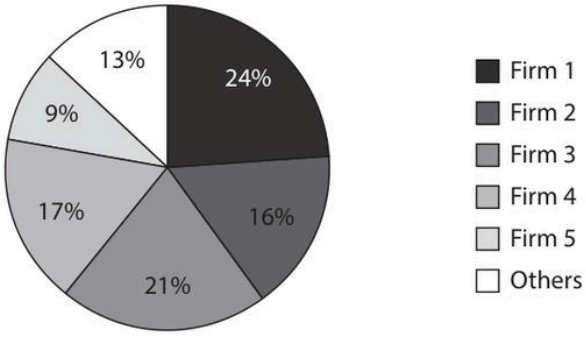


Figure 2

(a) Which **one** of the following options is the most suitable term for the type of market shown in Figure 2?

(1)

- ☒ **A** Monopoly
- ☒ **B** Oligopoly
- ☒ **C** Public sector
- ☒ **D** Labour

(b) Which **one** of the following is a reason why consumers may not maximise their benefit?

(1)

- ☒ **A** Consumers may not accurately calculate benefits
- ☒ **B** Consumers may find it easy to give up habits
- ☒ **C** Consumers never copy the behaviour of others
- ☒ **D** Rational decisions are always made by consumers

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6. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark

2024 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

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Figure 3 shows some of the production costs in the month of September for a firm manufacturing rugby souvenirs in France, in preparation for the 2025 Six Nations tournament.

Production costs	Euro (€)
Rent	7000
Raw materials	3000
Advertising	1300
Labour (paid according to output)	18000

Figure 3

(c) Calculate the **total variable costs** for the firm in the month of September. You are advised to show your working.

(2)

(d) What is meant by the term total revenue?

(2)

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6. Question 2 · part b · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

1 When a firm increased its prices, many consumers stopped buying its products.

(a) Which **one** of the following explains the behaviour of these consumers?

(1)

- ☒ **A** Consumers aim to maximise profit
- ☒ **B** Consumers aim to maximise benefits
- ☒ **C** Consumers have habits that are hard to give up
- ☒ **D** Consumers cannot calculate their benefits

A product has an income elasticity of demand (YED) of –0.9

(b) Which **one** of the following best describes the product?

(1)

- ☒ **A** A public good
- ☒ **B** A normal good
- ☒ **C** A luxury good
- ☒ **D** An inferior good

(c) What is meant by the term productivity?

(2)

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7. Question 1 · part a · 1 mark · Working and answer

Working and answer

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